

Sal Stewart

22.3 years old
Service Time: .028

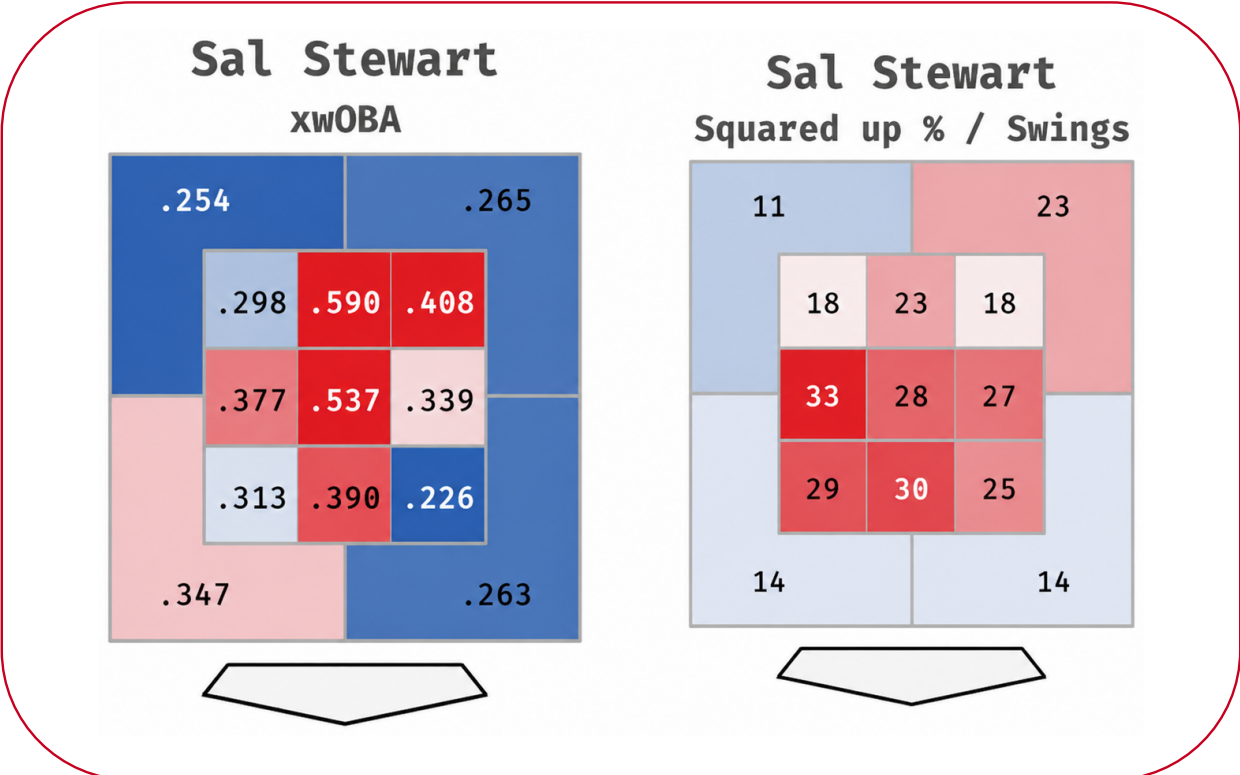
#27
Bats: Right
Throws: Right

G	AVG/OBP/SLG	HR	RBI	SB	BsR	wRC+	DRS	fWAR
145	.264/.335/.477	31	107	15	-1.9	118	-5	2.5

HOW PITCHERS ADJUSTED TO STEWART’S HOT START

Stewart started scorching hot in 2026 before pitchers adjusted their game plans. May was the worst month for Stewart, accumulating a 95 wRC+ and a .337 xwOBA over that span, down from his 152 wRC+ start. Stewart himself said pitchers were starting to change their game plans against him to get his timing off, causing him to miss his pitches. When the pitcher is able to get him off his timing, he is more susceptible to getting under the ball. In March and April, Stewart produced 19 barrels in 134 PAs, with a 44.6% hard-hit%. In 119 PAs in May, he had only 6 barrels, with a hard-hit% of 34.6%.

THE ADJUSTMENT: TIMING AND PITCH RECOGNITION



Stewart’s xwOBA and squared-up rate per swing by zone.

The most impressive part of Stewart’s game is the ability to display multiple swings and approaches based on the situation. With RISP, Stewart is slashing .313/.376/.597 with a wRC+ of 149 and a BB% of 11.6% and a K% of 16.8%. With the bases empty, Stewart slashes .257/.336/.470, still good for a wRC+ of 120, but with a BB% of 9.5% and a K% of 24.1%. Stewart will chase and take more free swings to chase his power, increasing his chase rate by 3% with the bases empty. Stewart shortens up, becoming more compact and direct to the ball, reducing the length of his swing to gain more barrel control in delivery.

SITUATIONAL SWING ADJUSTMENTS

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More impressive than any individual tool has been Stewart’s adaptability to different pitch mixes and game situations. His ability to deploy multiple approaches depending on the count and situation, while also making in-season adjustments as pitchers changed how they attacked him, points to an advanced level of baseball sense. That adaptability should remain one of the most important parts of his offensive development as he becomes more familiar with MLB pitching and continues facing new counter-adjustments. Stewart’s tools outside of his bat have received more scrutiny as he has been compared with JJ Wetherholt and Carson Benge in the Rookie of the Year race.